

Trak Football - Business Model Matrix

The five parts of a business, per persona

The honest starting point

Two of the five parts are **fully built**, one is **partly built**, and two **do not exist at all**.

Part	State today
1. Create value	Built and verified — the product works end to end
2. Attract attention	Nothing. No marketing, no landing narrative, no channel
3. Sales	Nothing. No one has ever paid for Trak
4. Deliver value	Built for coach, parent and club. Thin for the athlete
5. Bring in money	Nothing. No billing, no price, no decision on who pays

Writing this down is the point of the exercise: Trak is a **working product without a business around it**. That is a normal and fixable position, but it should not be mistaken for being close to revenue.

Part 1 — Create value

Why — Youth football runs on opinion. A coach's judgement of a child lives in their head, is never written down, and disappears when the coach or the season changes. Nobody can see whether a child is actually developing
What — A trustworthy, continuous record of a young player's development — performance **and** conduct — that a coach produces in minutes and a parent, player and club can all see
How — Coach logs matches and assesses six dimensions → a band. Player receives feedback and carries an Evolution Card and Passport. Parent observes. Club sees consistency across its coaches
The need — Without this Trak is a diary. The value is not the data — it is that the data is **believable**

The insight that should govern every decision: the product is not the tracking. It is the **trust**. A parent believing a rating, an academy acting on it, a child taking it seriously. This is why the write-authorisation flaw mattered so much more than a normal bug: a player able to fabricate their own assessments did not break a feature, it destroyed the only thing being sold.

Part 2 — Attract attention

Why — Nobody is looking for Trak. Coaches do not search for "player assessment software" — they are volunteers and part-timers with no budget line and no habit of buying tools
What — Reach the **club or academy**, not the individual coach. One conversation covers 10 coaches and 200 families
How — Not ads. Direct relationships: academies, then schools. The Greek market first, where founder relationships are real. The Evolution Card and Passport are inherently shareable — a proud parent posting their child's card is the cheapest marketing that exists

The need — A single, repeatable sentence that makes a director of football lean forward. That sentence is the output of this whole document

Do not build a marketing funnel yet. With zero paying customers the goal is not scale, it is **one pilot that works and can be pointed at.**

Part 3 — Turn interest into payment

Why — Everything Trak does costs money to run and nothing comes in. Without this part Trak is a hobby

What — A pilot → paid conversion for an academy or school. Not self-serve signups

How — One cohort, one term, free or near-free. Agree success measures **with** them up front. Convert on evidence, not enthusiasm

The need — **The decision on who pays.** Until that is settled, nothing here can be built

Who pays — the central unresolved question

The people who get the most value for the least effort are **not** the people doing the work.

Persona	Effort required	Value received	Can they pay?
Coach	High — logs everything	High	Rarely. Often volunteers
Athlete	Low today	Medium	No
Parent	None	High	Yes, but pays per child — small and churny
Club / Academy	None	High	Yes. Has a budget

Recommendation: the club or academy pays. One sale covers many coaches and hundreds of families, they hold the budget, they carry the reputational motive, and it avoids charging a volunteer coach for the privilege of doing unpaid work. Parent-pays looks tempting because parents care most emotionally, but it monetises a child's development record directly to their family — uncomfortable in itself, and worse for a school pilot.

Part 4 — Deliver value

Why — Value promised and not felt is worse than never promising it. In youth sport a tool that gets abandoned mid-season damages the club's trust in you permanently

What — Each persona must feel the value **in their own terms**, not ours

How — Coach: fast, low-friction, makes them look professional. Athlete: feedback comes back and progress is visible.

Parent: sees their child without having to ask. Club: consistency across coaches

The need — Delivery is where Trak is currently strongest — and where the one real hole is

What we risk, and how we mitigate it

Risk	Why it is real	Mitigation
Coach stops logging	They do all the work and are unpaid. If it takes more than a couple of minutes it stops in week three	Ruthless friction reduction. Quick assess, quick log. Treat every extra tap as a threat to the business

Athlete never opens it	Today the app is done to them — they receive, they never act	The character feature is the answer: the one place the child does the work
Parent sees an empty screen	Has happened twice already — finished screens returning nothing behind a missing permission	Never ship a persona view without exercising it as that persona against real data
Ratings are not believed	If the record can be gamed, or a coach rates carelessly, the whole proposition dies	Authorisation is enforced, not assumed. Assessments are immutable. The fairness flag exists
Season ends and it dies	Youth football is seasonal; attention drops in summer	The Passport is a career record. Value accumulates across seasons — the longer you use it the more it is worth leaving

How we measure delivered value

Not vanity metrics. For each persona, the one number that says value landed:

Persona	The measure that matters
Coach	% of sessions and matches actually logged, in week 8 — not week 1
Athlete	Do they open the app between matches?
Parent	Do they return without being prompted?
Club	Assessment consistency across coaches; does the director cite it in a real decision?

Part 5 — Bring in enough money to keep going

Why — Trak currently has running costs and no revenue. Company formation, accountant and contributions arrive before the first euro does

What — Recurring revenue from clubs and schools. Per-squad or per-club, annual, aligned to the season

How — Does not exist. There is no billing code, no plans, no prices

The need — Price cannot be set from a spreadsheet. It comes from the pilot — what an academy says out loud when asked what this is worth

The persona matrix — value, effort, emotion

This is the part that becomes the pitch. **Nobody buys features; they buy relief from a fear.**

Persona	What they actually want	What they fear	The sentence that lands
Coach	To be taken seriously as a developer of players, not a weekend volunteer	Looking disorganised. Being unable to justify a decision to an angry parent	"You will never again be asked why a child isn't playing and have nothing to show"

Athlete	To know whether they are good enough, and to be seen	Being overlooked. Working hard and nobody noticing	"Your season is recorded. What you did doesn't disappear when the coach changes"
Parent	To know their child is progressing and being cared for	Being in the dark. Their child quietly neglected while others are favoured	"You'll see how your child is doing without having to corner the coach after training"
Club / Academy	Reputation and consistency across coaches	A coach damaging the club's name. Losing families to a rival academy	"Every coach assesses to the same standard, and you can see it"

What Trak is – and what it is not

Being explicit about the "is not" is what keeps the product from drifting.

Trak is	Trak is not
A development record – performance and character	A scouting or talent-ID marketplace
Coach-led and coach-owned	A place where children rate themselves
A long-term career passport	A match-day statistics product
A tool for the average academy	An elite-club analytics suite competing with Hudl or Veo
Honest about what it measures	A promise to make anyone a professional
Private between coach, child and parent	A public leaderboard or a comparison engine

The last row is a commercial decision, not just an ethical one: the moment children are publicly ranked, schools stop returning calls.

The pitch this produces

Youth football runs on opinion. A coach's judgement lives in their head, is never written down, and vanishes when the season or the coach changes – so nobody can see whether a child is actually developing.

Trak gives every coach in your academy the same two-minute routine, and turns it into a record a parent believes, a player is proud of, and you can point to.

Same standard across every coach. Nothing hidden from parents. Nothing that ranks one child against another.

The one decision that unblocks the most

Who pays. Parts 3 and 5 cannot be built until it is settled, and it changes the product: per-club billing needs organisation-level accounts and seats, per-parent billing needs consumer payments and subscription management — very different work.

Recommendation as above: **the club or academy pays**, validated by the pilot rather than assumed.

Open questions for discussion

1. Do we agree the club pays — or is there a case for the school as the buyer, given the character direction?
2. Is the athlete a **user** or a **beneficiary**? The character feature only makes sense if they are a user, and that changes what we promise.
3. What is the smallest thing an academy would pay for **today**, before the character feature?
4. Do we sell development, or do we sell **evidence**? They attract different buyers.